

## THE LANGUAGE OF THE UNCONSCIOUS

Greetings, my dearest, dearest friends. Blessings for every one of you. Blessed be this hour. May this lecture help you again to discover more of yourself, to widen and raise your consciousness, to deepen your grasp of reality.

The most powerful aspect in man's life is his unconscious. Everything favorable, pleasurable, advantageous, as well as his hardships, suffering, disappointments, unfulfillments, so-called "bad luck," the repetition of unfavorable patterns, all are determined by his unconscious thinking and feeling, his unconscious attitudes. This comprises a great deal more than is commonly understood. When man speaks of his fate, the fateful happenings and nonhappenings, the truth of the matter is that it is really nothing else but the governing force of unconscious factors. We have often discussed and explained why the unconscious is so much stronger than the conscious mind. To recapitulate briefly, it is so because conscious misconceptions and unrealistic outlooks are more easily detectable in their unrealism and can therefore be corrected. That which is hidden from awareness continues to govern you without your being able through your reason to change the unconscious outlook. Hence it is of utmost importance to detect such hindering outlooks hidden within.

It is often forgotten that the unconscious does not only harbor petrified wrong conclusions, destructive behavior patterns resulting from images, and negative emotions due to unresolved problems, but it also contains utter wisdom, divine truth, and the most constructive elements in the universe, constantly building up in unending creativity and love. These wells can be tapped to the degree that the obstructions are let out of their hiding place -- the unconscious. Then and then only will all the productive elements, which, too, are still hidden, rise to the surface.

Only when man is in a dynamic process of growth and development do these words become real. Until such time, these words are a theory and no more than that. Little by little, gradually as you begin to discover the strange, exciting, at times even slightly frightening, and yet exhilarating reality of your unconscious, you begin to have an inkling of the powerful facets that are buried in it. So it must be your striving on this path to detect as much as possible deep within yourself -- not only of that which is erroneous, but of all the productive elements behind the errors. To the degree that you liberate yourself from the rubbish of useless fears and misconceptions which divide you; constructive, creative, productive elements you never knew existed will be freed.

Why do I repeat this fact after having discussed it so often and in many different approaches and forms? My reason for doing so is that none of my friends are really and truly aware of the power of their unconscious, and how it still governs them in their daily lives in spite of considerable progress. I wish to help you to become more aware of this, to give you even more effective tools to discover more of these forces which govern you without you knowing it.

Before we come to more practical hints in this respect, let me discuss the following. Again this is not quite new, but this slightly new approach may enable you to get a better grasp of this important topic. Man's personality is a repetition, in smaller form, of the whole universe. Both the individual and the universe exist due to a certain distribution of various cosmic energies. The way these various energies work together, interact, and are arranged determines the harmonious or disharmonious existence of the created being -- man, universe, plant, or leaf. In their ideal and perfect creation and state, these energies and forces work together in perfect interaction, complementing one another rather than hindering one another. Hence, the created being emanates one unified cosmic current. Again this applies to a stellar system, an individual planet, as well as every entity inhabiting the individual planets, from mineral to the highest spiritual creature. The regulating, universal forces must be the same for all.

When a stellar system disintegrates, it is because contrary forces are at work -- the opposite from truthfulness, realism, awareness, consciousness -- so that two opposing forces create such tension that finally an explosion occurs and the entity annihilates itself through the pressure of two opposing energy currents. This is again applicable to a stellar system, a planet, or the decay of a leaf on a tree. To put it simply, the universe, up to a certain degree of development or awareness, consists of two primary currents: a yes-current and a no-current. The yes-current means everything constructive because it is according to truthful insight, which cannot help but breed love and unity. The no-current means destructiveness because inadvertently it deviates from truthfulness, thereby breeding hate and disunity. This general explanation, in which is contained an entire history of creation, applies to man's individual daily life as well as to great concepts in the history of creation.

From past experience, you know, my friends, that I do not ask you blindly to accept spiritual teachings that you cannot verify within yourself right now. For what applies to you personally must, in principle, apply to all creation. It is easy and absolutely feasible to detect the yes- and no-currents within yourself, in your daily lives, if you but learn to understand, to interpret the language of your personal unconscious. To do so requires a certain technique just as in learning any new language. It means practice, perseverance, and patience in order to learn the new symbols.

Language in any shape or form is a conglomeration of symbols. What else is language? When you say the word "table," it is a symbol for the object you use, that you know as such. The same applies to the language of your personal unconscious mind. And it is just as possible to learn its language as it is to learn any other language. But it takes as much time, effort, and practice. It no more comes to you by itself than your suddenly learning a new language without organized effort. Only it is infinitely more rewarding, more essential for your personal life to know the language of your unconscious than the knowledge of a dozen foreign earth languages.

The work on this path is many things. We have described it in various analogies and defined it in several ways. Among all the things this path signifies, it is also the learning of the language of the unconscious. When you do so, you are bound to detect the yes- and the no-current.

The yes-current is often (not always) the more predominantly noticeable because it is often conscious. Whenever you find yourself disturbed because of a persistent unfulfillment, you can be sure that both currents must be strongly at work, thus putting the brakes on. Consciously, the yes-current is the stronger in order to blot out the unconscious no-current. The more the latter is

squelched in the erroneous idea that this eliminates it, the more is it driven underground where it continues to do its work. And the more this is the case, the more urgent and frantic does the yes-current become. They pull the personality in two opposite directions, creating stronger and stronger tension and pressure. The way to eliminate this short circuit is to uncover the no-current, understand its faulty premises, and thereby gradually shed the "necessity" for its existence.

It will be helpful for every one of you to approach himself, his life, in this way. It sounds, and really is, simple, but it is not oversimplified, for this is indeed the way it is.

In those areas of your life where things go easy, where you appear to be lucky, where most of the time you are fulfilled without any problematic and confusing crises, you can be sure that there is very little no-current involved and a predominant yes-current -- not only consciously but there is no contradictory hidden undercurrent. To put it differently, not only the surface attitude, but the attitude of your entire being is undivided and in accord with reality. You are not split in motivation and in desire.

But in areas in which you are repeatedly unlucky, the no-current must be at work in one form or another, for one reason or another. Of course, these may vary with each individual, but they have to be determined and clearly defined in order to inactivate them. Most of you have begun to detect them, or at least important facets of them.

Any goal you consciously desire and nevertheless do not attain is proof that an undetected no-current is at work. It is not sufficient to gain or have gained understanding of your images and misconceptions, nor how and why they came into existence in the particular circumstances of your childhood. Important work as that is, it is only one step. In this respect, most of you have made considerable progress. But it is not sufficient, for you are all mistaken when you believe that now, having found these misconceptions, these erroneous conclusions, this will automatically change your innermost, subtle emotional reactions. It does not work that way, and this assumption only leads to the illusion that your finding and your momentary relief has already liberated you, while you continue to react in the old way without being aware of it. Sooner or later, this is bound again to produce negative results, which then come as a double disappointment and discouragement.

The only way change can come about is through detection of how the no-current continues to work, even prohibiting the very change so ardently striven for by the yes-current. For that purpose, you really have to master the language of the unconscious.

Let us assume you wish a certain fulfillment in your life, a fulfillment you have lacked until now. You may have been aware of a strong desire for this fulfillment, and in your pathwork you have discovered certain unconscious misconceptions, false guilts, and destructive attitudes that prohibit this fulfillment. You may have even discovered a fear of the very fulfillment you wish and consequently a subtle attitude of rejecting it. The fear may be based on entirely illusory reasons and therefore be unnecessary. It may be due to the childish desire of not wanting to pay the necessary price connected with the fulfillment. It may be a feeling of not deserving this happiness. It may be any number of further "reasons" or a combination of all of them. Whatever they are, you have in essence discovered that which stands in your way. You may experience this discovery as a one time nucleus, as it were, like a package of disturbance. But it rarely occurs to my friends that this

"package" continues to send forth its expressions in spite of having been detected. And this is the important part of the work, without which real liberation cannot be.

In view of all this, it is very necessary to renew your efforts in daily detection of the no-current at work. Its manifestations may be ever so subtle, diffuse, and almost too elusive to catch. But if you set out to do so, what was once so hazy as to be almost impossible to formulate will become obvious. It will stand out in clear contour. You will discover how you slightly cringe back at the thought of the fulfillment whenever it approaches reality. When it is playful fantasy, all may be well. You may detect a vague feeling of uneasiness you are used to pushing aside when you think about the fulfillment. Is it a feeling of fear or false guilt that you do not deserve it? Whatever it is, try to take these vague, hazy emotional impressions, and question them in the daylight of consciousness. Examine the faraway fantasy when, apparently, only the yes-current is at work. But in this fantasy, do you wish for the impossible in that you do not take into consideration the human imperfections in all concerned? Do you fantasize in a spirit of having it all your way, which may not be bad or wrong, but upon closer examination is rigid, one-sided, unreal? In this fantasy, do you express an attitude of the expectation of being favoured, to the exclusion of flexibly adjusting to new circumstances in which you give of yourself by being able to compromise, renounce? In short, do you subtly feel that life should furnish you with the ideal fulfillment without necessitating change, adjustment, relinquishing on your part? This may be extremely subtle, and it requires all your discernment to discover this prevalent attitude. When you do, you will have a reason for the existence of the no-current, which functions exclusively when it comes to reality, but not in the one-sided fantasy. In such one-sided fantasy, you may even be willing to give of yourself, but only because in the fantasy you direct the play and thus determine how, when, in what way. In reality, you cannot determine all that. And it requires of you to be ready with your flexibility when that is necessary. Because you unconsciously know all that, you block the fulfillment, somehow waiting for the impossible.

When you become aware of the constantly working no-current, even before fully understanding its presence, you will find relief of hopelessness and the way out will be in sight. You will understand why your life has not changed in spite of extensive recognitions of images and childhood lessons. You will not detect the destructive feelings in the service of the no-current: fear, guilt, anger, frustration, hostility, etc. These feelings continue to smolder, but they may be artfully camouflaged, explained away by apparent reality provocations, and "successfully" projected onto others. Discovering all these mechanisms is learning the language of the unconscious. This is a successful translation of it.

No matter how many findings you make, nothing will really change in your life until you observe the no-current in action daily, again and again, until you interpret its messages and decipher its codes.

Before you can discover the no-current behind a strong unfulfilled wish, you may often be puzzled because the yes-current is so desperately urgent. Instead of letting this mislead you to assume that this is proof of the absence of a no-current, you may rather be certain that it is proof of its presence. The frantic fear that this desperate urgency will not be fulfilled always heralds an underground "no" to the fulfillment. Absence of such a "no" produces an easy, relaxed yes-current without a tinge of desperation. It wants the fulfillment, is wholly ready for it with all that this implies, but is utterly capable of leading a constructive life without it regardless of how welcome the

fulfillment would be. If it cannot be for various outer reasons, if the detection of the no-current happened at too late a period so that outwardly this particular fulfillment is excluded, the personality will know that other ways are open for the experience of a productive life situation.

Let us now be more specific about the detection of a no-current. To recapitulate, you may be sure it exists if frustration remains in your life in spite of having found relevant images, of having understood in principle and theory, and perhaps having occasionally felt destructive attitudes and behavior patterns. You may also be sure about its existence if you are desperate in your yes-current; if you fear the fulfillment will never come; if you believe your life is dismal without it. After having thus determined that it must exist, it is now a question of experiencing it -- not just once but whenever it is at work.

To become more acutely aware of its existence, the practice of the daily review, as you have learned, is immensely helpful if applied in this direction. Observation and questioning of your emotional reactions must extend in width and depth on the path, not diminish. If you progress in the right direction without undue blockage, you will now observe more rather than less (in the mistaken idea that there is less to see because of your improvement). Close scrutiny of your emotions is a number one prerequisite.

Of equal importance is to stir up the petrified part of the unconscious. If left alone, untouched, unchallenged; the obstructions, the no-current, do not manifest. They quietly slumber. Only when shaken up do they react in a more noticeable fashion. Such stirring occurs through the frustrations and difficulties life brings in its wake. It also occurs through constantly questioning the self, by trying to get through the outer, rational shell in a spirit of penetrating inner search.

Stirred up emotions reveal the no-current if these emotions are investigated, questioned, and understood. As I have said, this stirring occurs partly through the unavoidable life circumstances and partly through deliberate processes in the pathwork. In order productively to observe what the unconscious expresses, it is important to separate the healthy part of yourself from the unhealthy, confused, involved part. This detached observation of something obscure and strange is the healthiest and most healing procedure on the path of liberation. When your yes-current observes the no-current without frantic self-accusations, it will become possible to translate the latter into concise human language. This concise formulation of previously vague feelings is, as so often emphasized in the early stages of this path, another invaluable important aspect.

Man is so often erroneously convinced that to understand what occurs in his unconscious means merely the finding of hitherto unknown facets. He expects a completely unknown fact. This is true only in the rarest instances. It is not necessary to go through gyrations and distortions. Nothing unfeasible is required in order to discover what needs to be discovered so as to live a meaningful life. You do not have to wait for something faraway and completely hidden. First, observe those layers which are easily accessible if you but focus your attention on them. These are the half-conscious thoughts, the vague and diffuse attitudes and expressions which are almost second nature and therefore so easily overlooked because they have become a part of you. But none of these half-conscious feelings, reactions, and concepts is clearly formulated into concise thoughts. If you watch these half-conscious reactions in connection with the problem area of your life, you will learn all you need to know about yourself. This is a vital part of learning the language of your unconscious. I will not now discuss dream interpretation, which deals with the translation of deeper

layers. For this, help is needed even more than the observation of half-conscious material and its translation into your known language. This half-conscious material comprises your immediate emotional reactions, as well as your fantasy life. Comparison of both often demonstrates the discrepancies and contradictions in you, as well as the immature expectations.

The clearer you see how you push away or withdraw from the very fulfillment that you crave for -- see it again and again in action -- the closer do you come to eliminating the no-current. You weaken it by the mere observing of it.

When the petrified part of the unconscious is sufficiently badgered, partly as a result of the petrification itself, which is frustration and pain, and partly through the work on the path, the hardened part becomes sufficiently fluid to let go of some of its substance. This manifests in making the no-current appear strongly on the surface with less and less disguise, which is more and more difficult to rationalize. This can lead to the turning point, provided the no-current is not again strengthened in its old determination by an ego not watchful enough in this respect, not wary enough as to the machinations of the afflicted part of the resisting unconscious. If this is not prevented, the no-current may become the stronger again. Often this is temporary, but it happens frequently so that, unbeknown to the conscious self, the no-current has taken over. Please test yourself as to this possibility, at least in certain areas.

It is essential that you pay more attention to the no-current in its exact form. A further help is a certain type of meditation, the beginning stages of it I already suggested a number of years ago. I advised that you become very quiet and relaxed and begin by observing your thinking process -- initially your inability to observe your thinking process. This eventually leads to the ability of keeping thoughts out for a short while, of making yourself utterly empty. In this emptiness, it is possible for hitherto checked and repressed material to surface if you express this purpose and desire strongly enough and do not shy away from the effort to realize this goal. This is difficult at the beginning, but after a while a channel is established to that part in you that you could not previously tap. At first, it is the destructive elements you see floating up, and then you will be able to tap the constructive elements, hidden deeply within. Often the process is not exactly in that sequence. You may have uncovered certain destructive elements, and long before you know all of them and have enabled the entire afflicted, erroneous part to surface, some constructive elements will surface. In other words, it is not that "good" follows after all the "bad" has come out. It fluctuates. This may represent an additional test for man because it may lead him to a wishful thinking overestimation of himself and where he stands. Someone who has experienced some previously unmanifest creative, constructive soul material may not be further advanced than another who has not yet tapped this divine channel. They just have a different rhythm and organization.

In occult literature, the expression "the third eye" is often used. Through establishing contact with hidden unconscious areas and understanding the language of your unconscious obstructions, you develop "third" perceptive organs and functions of communication in every respect, not only eyes with which to see more clearly, but also ears, speech, and other senses of perception.

Metaphysical practices have succeeded in adequate training and disciplines in this respect, but only rarely are they used in the right direction. Man is always tempted away into the ideal state he has not yet reached so that newly acquired faculties are put into the service of escaping instead of

being used for the purpose of self-detection and understanding of the meaning and significance of destructive elements.

All this does require a certain discipline, as well as unflagging will power. The difficulty is that it is the very will power or determination lacking on the pathwork which is the identical no-current existing in the problem you so much wish to resolve. In other words, the brakes you inadvertently put on regarding the fulfillment you consciously desire, due to some unknown fear and rejection of this fulfillment, manifest in the work of the path in various ways. For example, lack of energy and desire, laziness, being blocked, not understanding, projecting anger on those who help, dramatizing and exaggerating actual difficulties until the pathwork is no longer possible or only in such a way as the real problems remain untouched. Important also is the insistence on concentrating on issues which the pathwork does not organically bring to your attention through life circumstances. These and various other manifestations are a sign that the same no-current is at work. To realize and be on the lookout for this is an essential part of a necessarily fundamental attitude to your work of self-realization. Although a substantial part of you is eager to detect, to find, to grow out of, to change where the problems exist -- meaning that a yes-current is at work -- there is also a deep fear of changing this problem. Hence, a no-current exists. It exists in a measure identical to the problem and the work. This no-current cannot be eliminated unless the deep fear which calls it into existence and its concomitant misconceptions are conscious, and your reason and intelligence can examine their validity. Therefore it is most advisable not to disregard the no-current and act as though it does not exist. It must be heeded, for it contains the key to the problem itself.

The important no-current is also called resistance. But this word has lost its meaning for you, and therefore the mere mention of it may only increase it. But if you realize that the no-current is a universal factor, present in your world in many facets, it might be easier for you to go about detecting it in yourself.

Every one of you is constantly involved in a no-current. It is not a question of whose is stronger and whose is weaker. The determining question is whether or not it is detected, observed, followed in its machinations, which must be more and more understood. A stronger no-current is less harmful, and is constantly weakened by this awareness, than an in itself puny, apparently weak but sluggishly obstinate one that clings to the personality in a most damaging fashion because it goes unobserved. These are the more difficult to find, especially when the yes-current is strong. So please, my friends, set out to discover your no-current, in what way it manifests as well as on what misconceptions it is based.

Your unconscious speaks steadily, my friends. It speaks without your hearing it so that you do not communicate with it and therefore miss a very important facet of your work. So often you go on searching for an intellectual understanding of one time misconceptions, thereby overlooking the steady flow of the no-current and in what way this happens. So this should become a task for you, with a main emphasis in your self-observations. If daily you devote a little time to this all-important issue, the results will be most wonderful.

Ask yourself these questions. (1) Which is the goal I want now? Where am I dissatisfied? What would I want to be different? (2) How much do I want it? (3) To what extent is there something in me that does not want it? or fears it? or, for one reason or another, says no to it? (4) If this no-current exists regarding the very thing I wish, it must also exist in the pathwork itself. In

what way does it manifest there? (5) How can I detect the various forms and manifestations of the no-current in my daily life?

If you clearly formulate these five questions and begin truthfully to answer them, your work on the path will be most dynamic, and your progress will astound and delight you. Again, the truthful answer to these questions, through steady observation, formulation of vague feelings, and meditation exercises cannot be a permanent one. Do not believe that what you now find suffices and needs no further attention. Rather it has to be observed continuously. Only then will it slowly weaken. Each observation may bring deeper and wider understanding.

To be very quiet and relaxed during these periods of self-confrontation is, as you know, essential. But if you have difficulty in this respect, if you feel too tense, too harassed and impatient, with a feeling that you are missing something else that is important without being able to name it, you can be sure that this is a typical manifestation of the no-current. It is the latter which prohibits you from becoming quiet and listening in to yourself. If you can acknowledge this, calmly stating to yourself, "I'm being too nervous and restless to relax and do this part of the work; this must be the no-current manifesting, prohibiting from me the very thing I want," then your restlessness will abate because you are in the truth of the now. The next step will be easier. You can then observe in action how it reacts, makes you react when you endeavor to work on your problem. If you continue to observe this, how at another time the no-current manifests perhaps in an entirely different way, but observe it calmly with all the keen one-pointed attention you can muster, your efforts must be crowned with success, and eventually you will eliminate that which is most destructive in you and your life. Instead you often storm ahead in your flights of fantasy to a faraway goal of perfection, while underneath you actually fear this very goal and thus overlook what actually stands in your way.

The yes-current must observe the no-current. Let this be your motto! To the degree that you are successful in this, thereby communicating with your own unconscious and understanding its language, to that degree will you establish a connection with a deeper, wiser part of your unconscious. This will eventually take over and guide you through all phases of your life, also those phases in which you have not been successful heretofore. This part must constantly furnish you with regenerative strength, creative energy, resourcefulness, harmony. But this can only come when you have learned to become aware of, observe, and decipher the unconscious where it is petrified and destructive. When you learn to do this with calm detachment, you will not only learn to communicate consciously with the constructive part of your unconscious, but you will also consciously communicate with the unconscious of other people. This means a great deal, my friends. You have begun to discover the truth of what I keep on saying, namely that all human beings constantly affect one another on their unconscious levels. These unaware communications determine the relationship. But being in a state of ignorance about this factor, not being able to grasp what is going on, must leave man hanging in the air. He often fails to understand what really happens in relationships. He fails to understand and to make himself understood. Therefore when you learn to consciously perceive the unconscious of others, understanding the interaction between you and them, you will experience a revolutionary liberation. It is indeed a vital threshold in your development. When this happens, you will see that there is no word to describe this phenomenon. It will be as though a dark curtain falls away from you. Misunderstandings, hurts, fears must cease to exist. You will see that what threatens you in others and makes you tense and defensive can be observed calmly in the way you have learned to do with your own self. You will learn to interpret in others as you have done with yourself. You will learn to interpret what this gesture, that emphasis,



this expression, that action, this utterance, that tense muscle mean, unbeknown to the person. You will hear, see, and perceive what the other person really means, what he wants to express in spite of his disguise, what he is governed by behind his conscious attitudes and facades. You will know what his unconscious says, when he behaves in such and such a way. When you arrive at this point, you have nothing further to fear. But this is an organic development which cannot happen before you have done it with yourself. As long as you are frightened, you lack the necessary calm observation to perceive in truthfulness, whether this concerns fright of what others might do to you or fright of your own unconscious. In the last lecture, I discussed the fear of your own unconscious, fear in connection with the fear of letting go in union with a mate and, the third in the triad, the fear of death. It is this fear of one's own unconscious which makes the no-current so strong. You will see here the interconnection of the triad of the last lecture and the liberation I discuss this evening -- when you no longer fear others because you can quietly take in and use all your functions and organs. Hence, this lecture can be truly understandable only if you verify the fear of your own unconscious. As you lose this fear, the more do you learn to interpret the language of your unconscious. Thus you perfect yourself more and more in the technique which establishes a fearless relationship to others.

Are there any questions now?

QUESTION: If one is aware of the fear in relation to his wishes, and the wish then diminishes because one fully realizes the fear, what can one do then?

ANSWER: The question is really not what one can do, but what this means. If the wish recedes because of the fear, it means that the fear is not understood, its misconceptions and unrealism are not seen in all connections and ramifications. If it were fully understood, it would most certainly diminish, not by being covered up but by really and truly dissolving. This means that the whole territory is not fully explored. There are so many loose ends. This remains to be done. Do you understand?

QUESTION: Yes, I do. But I still have the feeling... Can I give an example? For example, I have always wanted to be an actress. I couldn't do it because I feared that I wouldn't be as perfect as I wanted to be, and wouldn't want to take the risks involved. Now being older, I realize also that I couldn't do it anyway any longer. Now the wish still exists, but also the fear, and also the knowledge that it is too late.

ANSWER: You see, you have discovered here a relatively superficial cluster of emotions, reactions, and attitudes. This wish, with all that is attached to it, is a manifestation of something much deeper. We might truly say that it is a displacement. It is a manifestation of a deeper wish and a deeper fear. It is impossible to resolve a problem when one deals with the displacement of it. It must be dealt with, felt, experienced in its deep original manifestation. In order to make this possible, many restrictions, inhibitions -- the no-current -- must be fully conscious in most of its aspects. Only then can you relive the frustration and pain you suffered as a child and therefore still suffer often, only now it is not necessary to do so. It happens because you have instituted very destructive defenses against this original pain and frustration. One of them is an unusually strong no-current. It is the latter which makes it so difficult for you to unroll the whole process and become vibrantly alive regarding all that plays a role.

QUESTION: I understand that very well, I know that the displacement contains exactly the same thing. I feel the no-current.

ANSWER: Not fully, no. It is essential that you become more acutely and specifically aware of it as it manifests in your daily living, in your reactions, contacts, attitudes, in the work on the path itself. Only then will it be possible to penetrate where your consciousness has so far not been able to do so.

QUESTION: I have a question from an absent friend. She would like to know what the metaphysical mechanics are concerning the hardening of the brain arteries impairing a patient's mental capacities? Why does it happen? What can be done to help?

ANSWER: It happens due to a protective mechanism in the human psyche. It enables a personality, on the borderline between this manifestation of life and a different dimension of life, to make the period of transition less painful -- physically as well as mentally. Mental pain exists with individuals who are filled with fear and uncertainty. When inner problems remain unsolved, as you know, the fear of the unknown is very strong. The hardening of the brain arteries could almost be likened to a form of anesthesia that nature administers if necessary. This is a blessed thing indeed. This already answers the second question because when this is understood and seen in this light, understanding will eliminate an inner current of anxiety which in turn would be picked up by the patient's unconscious. Fears therefore become burdens, hence the absence of apprehension brings further relief. If you no longer push and press against this process but gratefully see it as what it is, there will be no pressure from you to the unconscious of the patient. This will make it easier to give in to this relief instead of fighting against it in shame and a false conscience. This may happen in an ever so subtle way.

Please preserve the questions that come up spontaneously after these lectures. This requires a little discipline, but it is so useful and well worth your efforts to ask and discuss at the periods destined for this. Thoughts and ideas are often fleeting. A question or a parallel out of your own pathwork may occur to you as you listen or read. Do give all other friends the benefit of your sharing, and yourself a further elaboration on a point which might prove very helpful for you, by jotting down what occurs to you.

Let us hope that this lecture, in spite of much repetition in essence, conveyed something new to you, thus giving you a new incentive and motor force to approach yourself in a spirit of detached observation. When you find a difficulty to do so, do not override this difficulty, but take it in itself as language, as expression, and interpret it.

Be blessed, all of you, in body, in soul, and spirit. Be in peace, my dearest friends. Be in God!

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